

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 569

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to celebrate George Washington's birthday.

WHEREAS, George Washington's birthday on February 22 is celebrated annually to acknowledge the many sacrifices and contributions President Washington made for our young country and for his service as "Father of our Country"; and

WHEREAS, in 1775, George Washington was appointed Commander in Chief of the Continental Army, serving with great character and leadership for eight and one-half years without pay, leading the American Army to victory against the British; and

WHEREAS, George Washington established the primacy of civilian rule when, in 1783, he stood down a proposed mutiny against Congress by soldiers who had not been paid and voluntarily relinquished his military commission, returning to his beloved farm, Mount Vernon; and

WHEREAS, George Washington advanced the rule of law by chairing the Constitutional Convention, signing the U.S. Constitution, and thereafter dedicating himself and his fellow countrymen to creating "a more perfect union"; and

WHEREAS, George Washington was elected unanimously to be the first President of the United States; and

WHEREAS, during his presidency, George Washington established many enduring values, including the principle of religious freedom set out in his *Letter to the Touro Synagogue*; and

WHEREAS, George Washington modeled the peaceful transfer of power when, voluntarily, he chose to step down after eight years as President; and

WHEREAS, George Washington freed his slaves upon his death, thereby publicly acknowledging that the institution of slavery was antithetical to the principles of the American republic; and

WHEREAS, George Washington died on December 14, 1799, at his home, Mount Vernon, and upon Washington's death, John Adams said, "His example is now complete, and it will teach wisdom and virtue to magistrates, citizens and men, not only in the present age, but in future generations, as long as our history shall be read"; and

WHEREAS, George Washington's Mount Vernon welcomes Tennesseans throughout the year and sponsors Teachers' Institutes, which give Tennessee teachers the unique opportunity to study and learn about George Washington; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we join with all American citizens across the nation in the annual celebration of George Washington's birthday on Sunday, February 22, 2026.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.